

Infrared A type of electromagnetic radiation that carries energy in invisible waves from hot objects.

Insulator A material that does not let heat or electricity flow easily through it.

Intake The amount of food, water, air, or another substance taken into the body or a machine.

Iron Age A historical period after the Bronze Age that is defined by the use of iron as the most important material for making weapons and tools. It began around 1200 BCE in the Middle East, and spread around the world over about 1,500 years.

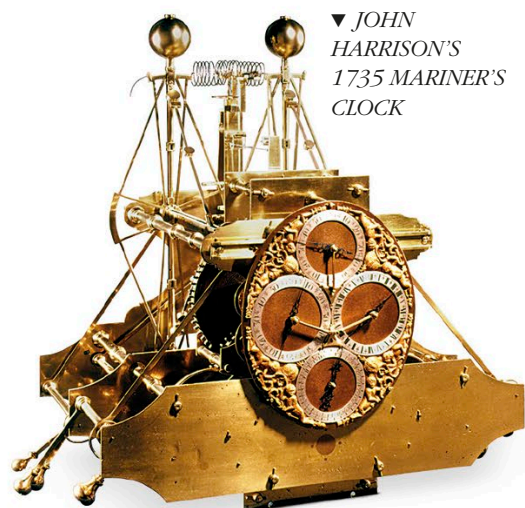
Laser The acronym for light amplification by stimulated emission of radiation. A laser can produce a very powerful beam of light by exciting atoms inside a tube.

LED An acronym for light-emitting diode. An LED is a device that produces light when an electric current passes through it. The color of its light depends on the compounds used in it.

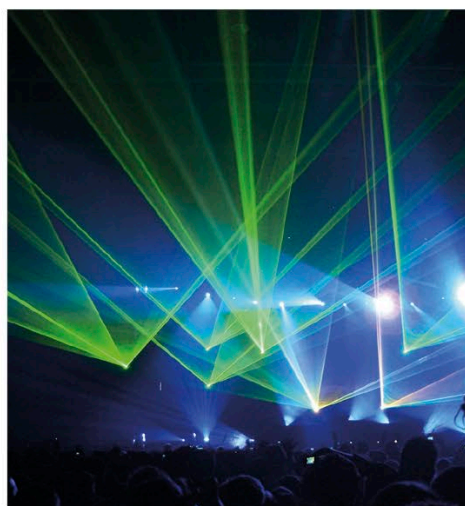
Lever A tool that increases a small force into a large force—for example, a person exerts a small force on a nutcracker by squeezing it and breaking a nut.

Levitation The act of rising up or hovering in the air.

Magnet A piece of iron that attracts metals with iron or steel in them.



▼ JOHN HARRISON'S 1735 MARINER'S CLOCK



▲ LASER SHOW AT A CONCERT

Magnetic field The area surrounding a magnet that is able to attract objects to itself.

Mesopotamia Present-day Iraq and its surrounding areas, between the Tigris and Euphrates rivers.

Medieval A term that describes something, such as a painting or building, made during a period of European history from about 600–1500.

Mezzotint An engraving technique that involves scraping and polishing a copper plate.

Microbe A living organism too small to be seen with the unaided eye. There are three main types of microbe: bacteria, viruses, and fungi. They can be beneficial or harmful to plants and animals.

Microwave A very short, electromagnetic wave used for radar, cooking food in a microwave oven, or for sending information by radio.

Module (space) A self-contained part of a spacecraft.

Mold A soft growth that develops on rotting food or on some items that are left for a long time in humid conditions.

NASA An acronym for National Aeronautics and Space Administration. Based in the US, NASA studies space and is responsible for space travel.

Navigation The process of finding the position of a car, ship, or aircraft and the best route from there to somewhere else.

Neutron A particle inside an atom that has no charge.

Nuclear reactor A device designed to maintain and control nuclear reactions. They are used mainly for electricity generation in nuclear power plants.

Nucleus The center of an atom that is made up of protons (positively charged particles) and neutrons (particles with no charge).

Nutrient A food or any nourishing substance that plants or animals need to live and grow.

Orbit The path that an object takes in space when it moves around a star, planet, or moon.

Ore A rock or mineral from which a useful element can be purified and isolated.

Oscillate The act of moving in a back-and-forth fashion, like that of a pendulum.

Patent A legal application to protect a product and the way it is made from being copied by another person or company.

Payload The amount of objects or people on an aircraft or a spacecraft.

Pendulum A weight suspended from a fixed point that swings freely back and forth under the force of gravity. A pendulum is commonly used to regulate movements, for example in clocks.

Pesticide A chemical substance that is used for destroying insects or other organisms that are harmful to plants or animals.

Phonetic The use of written language to represent different sounds made in speech.

Pollution The introduction of a substance into an environment that has harmful or poisonous effects.